

Restoration Ethics Studio Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 30-40 min

Category	The Arts	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	restoration-ethics-studio

Big idea: Preserving an artwork can also alter what future viewers know through it.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students decide how to restore a damaged artwork and analyze how restoration choices affect authenticity and knowledge.

Student Prompt

Inspect Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scenario: a mural has faded paint, later graffiti, and a damaged corner. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Restoration Ethics Studio Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Preserving an artwork can also alter what future viewers know through it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Restoration Ethics Studio Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does restoration preserve knowledge or create new meaning?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how preserving an artwork can also alter what future viewers know through it.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Does restoration preserve knowledge or create new meaning?

Setup Checklist

- Use a fictional artwork so students can focus on trade-offs rather than external facts.
- Give each group a different stakeholder priority.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Scenario: a mural has faded paint, later graffiti, and a damaged corner.
- Options: clean only, repaint invisibly, preserve damage, add a modern label, commission a visible repair.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/restoration-ethics-studio/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/restoration-ethics-studio/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/restoration-ethics-studio/visual-prompt.svg>
- Restoration decision matrix: authenticity, artist intention, public access, historical trace, reversibility.
- Stakeholder cards: artist estate, museum, local community, conservator, visitor.

Run Sequence

1. Present a fictional damaged artwork and its background.
2. Groups inspect restoration options and stakeholder priorities.
3. Students choose a restoration plan and justify it with evidence and values.
4. Groups compare how each plan changes authenticity and viewer knowledge.
5. Debrief whether preservation can be a form of interpretation.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Does restoration preserve knowledge or create a new object of knowledge?
- What counts as authenticity in the arts?

- Who should decide how an artwork is preserved?

Teacher Quick Script

- Preservation is not neutral when every option changes what viewers encounter.
- What kind of authenticity are you prioritizing?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...